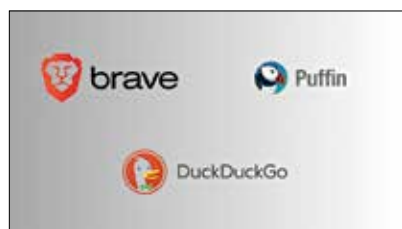


version of lite apps, which just needs to be accessed through any browser. These websites will function exactly the way any app does, just with one goal- using the lowest possible hardware value. Some such PWAs are Uber, Starbucks, Twitter etc.

15 Switch your browser

Google Chrome is the default browser for most users out there. But, unfortunately Chrome is a very heavy app. Thus, resulting in your phone getting slower and you might face a lag. So, you should switch to a lighter browser. According to certain benchmarks, Puffin



has been named as the fastest browser for Android. Other lighter browsers that you can use are Brave or DuckDuckGo. These browsing apps cut off the unnecessary junk available on different websites and speed up your browsing.

16 Home screen cleaning

Home screen consists of widgets, apps which load it up. They keep running in the background without your knowledge, eating up your phone's space yet again, slowing it down, and also affecting the battery. Widgets are useful for sure but not at the cost of the depletion of your phone's life. So, try and avoid widgets as much as possible when



your phone has started slowing down. Same goes for live wallpapers. So, it's best to avoid overcrowding your home screen and keep it sweet and simple.

17 Wi-Fi only updates

You definitely need your apps to be up to date, but again you can't allow them to get updated whenever they feel like. It would just result in the app update happening at the back-end and consuming your RAM, storage, data and battery. So, instead fix the option to allow apps to install only when you are connected to Wi-Fi. Also, this will help you prevent unnecessary apps from getting updated at the wrong time and just depleting your internet.

18 Avoid Auto-sync

If apps are allowed to auto-sync at any point then they will again just be running in the background and affecting the same way as any app update would. This would impact the speed of the phone. Don't completely remove the syncing, instead keep it under your control and reduce the frequency. The setting for syncing can be changed from app to app and it's recommended that you make sure that the syncing is set to activate when you're connected to a Wi-Fi network. Not only it helps save your data, but also reduces the frequency of the syncing.

19 Take care of the SD card

First, get to know your phone better and use the appropriate SD card. Check the limit of your expandable memory and get the SD card accordingly. If you don't use the appropriate SD card that can create a lot of chaos on your device.

Also, make sure your SD card is running at its best and is not corrupt. Else, if your phone experiences a lag or a crash it will definitely be due to the corrupt SD card. Keep a check on the data stored in the SD card and if it reaches the verge of exhausting the memory, do clean up your SD card and make sure whatever isn't required at all is elimi-

nated from your SD card. Also, if you are someone who lives close to the sea, then watch out for corrosion as well.

20 Disable hands-free Google Assistant

Google Assistant again runs in the background similarly. Yes it might seem very easy to just command "OK Google.." and say whatever you feel like, but at the end of the day it is just cutting off days from your phone's lifetime. Majorly when your device is ageing avoid any such activities as this would definitely slow down your phone.

21 Fall back to Factory settings when the situation demands

If your phone is dead slow and you aren't able to do anything properly, then factory resetting our old friend is the last possible option and the life support for your phone. First, duplicate all your necessary files somewhere else like your PC or laptop. Then go to settings and click on factory reset. It will wipe off everything and give it back to you as if it's the first day you are using it only internally but not the exterior look.

22 Reboot your smartphone from time to time

The way a human's body needs rest, your phone needs it too. Every second of the day your phone is doing something or the other so at a certain point it needs to rest as well. That is when you reboot your device. Rebooting your device helps in clearing cache, cleaning the RAM and also getting rid of any temporary functionalities. Once you reboot your device, you will definitely enjoy a certain smooth functioning of your phone. So, it will be recommended that whenever you want to just give your phone some rest by rebooting it.

At this point, we cannot think of a life without smartphones. But again if it doesn't function the way we want it to, we get agitated. So, we hope 22 tips will help your smartphone run smoothly until it comes to the end of its life-cycle. **d**